Lonjezo Sithole

Ph.D. Candidate, Department of Economics, University of Michigan

London, United Kingdom
lsithole@umich.edu

Education

University of Michigan — Ann Arbor, MI
Ph.D. Economics — Expected Spring 2027
M.A. Economics (en route to Ph.D.) — 2023

University of Edinburgh — Edinburgh, UK
MSc Econometrics, with Distinction — 2018–2019

University of Malawi — Zomba, Malawi
M.A. Economics, with Distinction — 2016–2018
Bachelor of Social Science (Economics), Upper Second Class — 2008–2012

Fields

Primary: Econometrics
Secondary: Machine Learning, Applied Microeconomics

Working Papers

Multimargin Selection in Leniency Designs **Job Market Paper**

Anatomy of the First Stage with Ordered Treatments

A Locally Robust Semiparametric Approach to Examiner IV Designs
Reject & Resubmit, *Journal of Econometrics*. Awarded the 2024 Outstanding Third Year Paper Prize. arXiv:2404.19144

Nonparametric Testability of Slutsky Symmetry (with Florian Gunsilius)
Submitted. arXiv:2505.05603

Work in Progress

Semisupervised Causal Inference with Unstructured Data

Fellowships & Awards

2026–2027	Rackham Predoctoral Fellowship, University of Michigan
2025–2026	Conference Travel Grants: Rackham Graduate School (2025); Department of Economics (2025, 2026)
2025	Lawrence Klein Fellowship in Econometrics, University of Michigan
2024	Outstanding Third Year Paper Prize, University of Michigan
2021–2022	Summer Research Apprenticeships, University of Michigan

Last updated: October 2026

2021	William Haber Fellowship, University of Michigan
2019	Prize for the Best Econometrics Project, University of Edinburgh
2018–2019	Beit–Edinburgh Scholarship, University of Edinburgh
2016	Global Young Leader, Johnson & Johnson
2012	Leader of Our Time, University of Malawi Graduating Class
2012	Defender of Academic Freedom, University of Malawi Academic Staff Union
2009–2010	Dean's Commendation for Best Performance, Faculty of Social Science, University of Malawi

Presentations

Conference Presentations

Multimargin Selection in Leniency Designs

2026	Canadian Econometric Study Group Annual Meeting, Vancouver, Canada (Plenary)
2026	Econometric Society Australasia Meeting, Adelaide, Australia (Oral)
2026	Econometric Study Group Annual Conference, Bristol, United Kingdom (Oral)
2026	Celebrating James G. MacKinnon's 75th Birthday Conference, Aarhus Center of Econometrics, Denmark (Oral, Main Program)

Nonparametric Testability of Slutsky Symmetry

2025	World Congress of the Econometric Society, Seoul, South Korea (Oral)
2025	International Association for Applied Econometrics Annual Conference, Turin, Italy (Oral)
2025	Canadian Econometric Study Group Annual Meeting, Ottawa, Canada (Poster)

Seminars

University of Michigan: Econometrics Seminar (2026); Econometrics Student Workshop (2025, 2026); Summer Econometrics Workshop (2025, two presentations); Labor Lunch Seminar (2024, 2025)

Professional Service

Referee: *Journal of Econometrics*

Discussant: *Discrete Choice with Endogenous Peer Selection* (Kashaev & Lazzati, 2025), 2025 Canadian Econometric Study Group Annual Meeting

Teaching

Graduate Student Instructor, University of Michigan

Econ 672 (First-Year Ph.D.): Econometric Analysis II — Winter 2026
Econ 675 (Second-Year Ph.D.): Applied Microeconometrics — Fall 2024, Fall 2025
Also delivered guest lectures on double/debiased machine learning in both terms.
Econ 504 (Master of Applied Economics): Econometrics for Applied Economics — Winter 2024
Econ 503 (Master of Applied Economics): Introduction to Probability & Statistics — Fall 2023
Econ 251 (Undergraduate): Introduction to Econometrics — Fall 2022, Winter 2023

Service & Extracurriculars

2024–Present	Advisor, Graduate International Applications Network (GAIN), University of Zurich
2022–Present	Advisor, Global Health Corps, New York
2023	Co-Founder, Black Economics Graduate Students Society, University of Michigan
2023	Department Steward, Graduate Employees Organization, University of Michigan
2022–2024	Coordinator, Graduate International Applications Network—Alumni Chapter
2022	DEI Representative, Graduate Economics Society (GES), University of Michigan
2018–2019	Program Representative, University of Edinburgh
2010–2012	President, University of Malawi Students Union

Previous Employment

World Bank, Washington, DC — 2019–2021
Short-Term Consultant

Malawi National AIDS Commission, Lilongwe, Malawi — 2014–2018
Monitoring & Evaluation Officer

Lighthouse Trust, Lilongwe, Malawi — 2013–2014
Monitoring & Evaluation Fellow, Global Health Corps Fellowship (New York)

Professional Memberships

Econometric Society; Institute of Mathematical Statistics; European Economic Association; Economic Association of Malawi

Additional Information

Citizenship: Malawian
Software: Advanced: R, Python, Git. Intermediate: Stata, Matlab.
Languages: English (Fluent); French (A2–Beginner); Spanish (Beginner)

Dissertation Committee

Kaspar Wüthrich (Co-Chair)
Department of Economics
University of Michigan
kasparwu@umich.edu

Florian Gunsilius (Co-Chair)
Department of Economics
Emory University
fgunsil@emory.edu

Eva Janssens
Department of Economics
University of Michigan
evaj@umich.edu

Andreas Hagemann
Ross School of Business
University of Michigan
hagem@umich.edu